

Karl Marx

The man who thought society should be different, and put the REVOLT into revolting peasants

All about me

- BORN: 1818
- DIED: 1883
- NATIONALITY: German
- FACTOID: I died before my ideas were widely recognized.
- IN A NUTSHELL: I was born in Trier, Germany. I started off as a journalist, but had some radical ideas about how people should live.

A new society

Marx believed that **capitalist societies** (where people work to maximize profit) were run by the rich *for their own benefit*, and the lower classes could only suffer. He came up with an new idea for a classless society. In this type of society, everyone would have a fair share of the goods and wealth produced. This became known as **COMMUNISM**.

Das
Kapital

In 1867, Marx published his ideas in the book "Das Kapital."

The people revolt

Marx's teachings had their first great triumph during the **Russian Revolution**. In 1917, Russia's lower classes *overthrew the Russian royal family*. The country's new leader, Vladimir Lenin, based his government on Marx's ideas and created a proletarian dictatorship (a country ruled by the lower classes). In 1922, Russia became the **SOVIET UNION**.

